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seetland, the menætft of the human race. To acute me of following the death of the queen my filter, is to brand me with he infany which I sabro molt. It is my nature to employ the direction and Efter, and not the fwof of Judith. Elizabeth herself will attach, that I have often admitted her was to draw upon her head the retention of my friends by the economy of her eruties to me. My innocence cannot finely be doubted; and it is known to the Almighty God, I could not potify think to forcego his mercy, and to ruin my folly, in order to compels a transgirtion fo horrible as that or her murders. But amidt the time ment and impropried pretences which my silverfa-ries are pleased to invent to overvelmim me with cala- mules and angelit, I can trace and discover with erie the next cause of their mobility and promotion. My crimes are my birth, the injuries I have been com- pelled to endure, and y religion. I am proud of the first, I can forgive the freedom, and she tried in a fource to me of fuch comfort and hope, that for its glory I will be contested that my blood fall flow upon the faithful?

To the defense of Mary, a returns were made befe flace and indisporaffitions of the field of the evidence produced to her prejudice. In the course of the trial, however, there occurred some incidents which defence to be rotated. By Lord Erleigh, who was willing to disconnect her, charged her with a fixed relation of conveying her claims and titles to England to the king of Spain. But though, in a discounted humonism with the fen, the had threatened to dinhent him, and had even corpoined on the failed, with her feet fetre friends, it appears that this project to be eradicated as only a transient effect of redefensement and puffion. She indeed acknowledged, that the Spaniard profited to have pretensions to the kingdom of England, and that a book in justification of them had been communicated to her. She declared, however, thus the had incorrect the displacement of many by disapproving of this book, and that no conveyance of her titles to the Spanish had been ever executed.

The trial continued during the space of two days but the commitment awaited to deliver their opinions. My lost Burleigh, in whole management Elizabeth chiefly condides, and whom the Scottish quen dicom-pofed in no common degree by her ability and vigors, being eager to consider the findings, demand to know if the bad any thing to add to what the bad gregd in her defence. She informed him, that the would be infinitely placed and geefied, if it should be permitted to her to be heard in her justification before a full meeting of the parliament, or before the queen and her privy-conned. This information was unsecc-ected, and the request implied in it was rejected. The court, in consequence of previous individuals from Elizabeth, adjored to a further day, and appointed that the place of its convention should be the flat- clamber at Wetherden, in accordingly attended these shows and Yaw and Curl, who had not been pro-duced a Motheringy coffee, were now called before the commillions. An cash to dealer the trust was put to then ,) and they definitely affirmed and protected that the declaration they had lubferbed was in every refect juit and faithful. Nothing farther remained,

8e d discuss to be heard before the parliament, a full meeting of the parliament, or before the queen.

but to pronounce femeence against Mary. The com- millifrons unanimously concurred in delivering it as their verdict or judgment, that the "was a party to judgment the conspiracy of Bologony, and that the had com-pafiled and imagined matters within the realm of Engi- landending to the hard, death, and delivered of the royal portion of Elizabeth, in opposition to the feature framed for her protection." Upon the fame day in which this extraordinary femeence was given, the com- millions and the judges of England lifted a declaration which imported, that it was not to derogate in any degree from the titles and honour of the King of Stots.

The reference against Mary was very foon afterwards ratified by the English parliament. King James there is there with herner as hearing of the execution of his English mattres; but that spiritilled prince could how his re-fentant so darker than by unwailing cheatles and remontances. France integrated in the flame in effectual manner, and on the 6th of December 1986, Elizabeth caufed the femeence of the commalliance against her to be proclaimed. After this the was made acquainted with her fate, and received the news with the greatest monopolies, and even apparent faith-fiction. Her keepers now refused to test her with any reverence or respect. They entered her apartments with their hands covered, and make no balance to her. They took down her canopy of date, and deprived her of all the budget of royalty. By thefe infringning institutions they meant to inform do that the had fnuk from the digity of a princely to the abject that of a criminal. She findeld, and fails. " Is defite of your foreign and one for laborivental judges, I will live and die a queen. My royal characters in-delibs; and it will fororder it with my finite to the Almaghy Goo, from whom I received it, and to whom my honor and my convinces are fully known." In this melancholy duration Mary adderfield a magan nouve letter Elizabeth, in which almost making the faultlicitation for her life, the only requested that her body might be carried to France; (that the might be publicly executed), that her terrains might be per-mitted to depart out of England undemolded, and enjoy the legacies which lie bequearched them. But to this letter no answer was given.

In the mean time James, who had neither adrefa nor courage to attempt any thing in behalf of his mother, announced her donation to his friend died in jects, and ordered prayers to be fail for her in all the churches. The form of the person for preferred was framed with delivery and caution, that the clever might have no objection to it. He enjoned them to pray, " that it might pleal Goo to college Mary with the light to the truth, and to proceeds her from the danger which was hanging over her." His own chapals, and Mr David Lindley mintier of Lerich, deferred his command. But all the other cergy referful to profitute their pulpits by preferring any pe-titions to the Almighty for a Papil. Jana, shocked with their point of anience and fictitious apportioned a new day for prayers to be fail for Mary, and illued a father injunction to the cergy to obey him, and that his might be for himself from any faults, the commanded the archibihop of St Andrews to preach be-fore him. The recietificates, diligutted with his injunc-

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Scotland.

the meaneſt of the human race. To accuſe me of ſcheming the death of the queen my ſiſter, is to brand me with the infamy which I abhor moſt. It is my nature to employ the devotions of Eſther, and not the ſword of Judith. Elizabeth herſelf will atteſt, that I have often admoniſhed her not to draw upon her head the reſentment of my friends by the enormity of her cruelties to me. My innocence cannot ſincerely be doubted; and it is known to the Almighty God, that I could not poſſibly think to forego his mercy, and to ruin my ſoul, in order to compaſs a tranſgreſſion ſo horrible as that of her murder. But amidſt the inclement and unprincipled pretences which my adverſaries are pleaſed to invent to overwhelm me with calamities and anguiſh, I can trace and diſcover with eaſe the real cauſes of their hoſtility and provocation. My crimes are my birth, the injuries I have been compelled to endure, and my religion. I am proud of the firſt; I can forgive the ſecond; and the third is a ſource to me of ſuch comfort and hope, that for its glory I will be contented that my blood ſhall flow upon the ſcaffold."

To the defence of Mary, no returns were made beſide ſtout and unſupported affirmations of the truth of the evidence produced to her prejudice. In the courſe of the trial, however, there occurred ſome incidents which deſerve to be related. My lord Burleigh, who was willing to diſcompoſe her, charged her with a fixed reſolution of conveying her claims and titles to England to the king of Spain. But though, in a diſcontented humour with her ſon, ſhe had threatened to diſinherit him, and had even correſponded on the ſubject with her ſelect friends, it appears that this project is to be conſidered as only a tranſient effect of reſentment and paſſion. She indeed acknowledged, that the Spaniard profeſſed to have pretenſions to the kingdom of England, and that a book in juſtification of them had been communicated to her. She declared, however, that ſhe had incurred the diſpleaſure of many by diſapproving of this book; and that no conveyance of her titles to the Spaniard had been ever executed.

The trial continued during the ſpace of two days; but the commiſſioners avoided to deliver their opinions. My lord Burleigh, in whoſe management Elizabeth chiefly confided, and whom the Scottiſh queen diſcompoſed in no common degree by her ability and vigour, being eager to conclude the buſineſs, demanded to know if ſhe had any thing to add to what ſhe had urged in her defence. She informed him, that ſhe would be infinitely pleaſed and gratified, if it ſhould be permitted to her to be heard in her juſtification before a full meeting of the parliament, or before the queen and her privy-council. This intimation was unexpected; and the requeſt implied in it was rejected. The court, in conſequence of previous inſtructions from Elizabeth, adjourned to a farther day, and appointed that the place of its convention ſhould be the ſtar-chamber at Weſtminſter. It accordingly aſſembled there; and Naw and Curl, who had not been produced at Fotheringay caſtle, were now called before the commiſſioners. An oath to declare the truth was put to them; and they definitely affirmed and proteſted that the declaration they had ſubſcribed was in every reſpect juſt and faithful. Nothing farther remained,

816 She deſires to be heard before the parliament, or before the queen.

but to pronounce ſentence againſt Mary. The commiſſioners unanimouſly concurred in delivering it as their verdict or judgment, that ſhe "was a party to the conſpiracy of Babington; and that ſhe had compaſſed and imagined matters within the realm of England tending to the hurt, death, and deſtruction of the royal perſon of Elizabeth, in oppoſition to the ſtatute framed for her protection." Upon the ſame day in which this extraordinary ſentence was given, the commiſſioners and the judges of England iſſued a declaration which imported, that it was not to derogate in any degree from the titles and honour of the king of Scots.

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817 Judgment given againſt her.

The ſentence againſt Mary was very ſoon afterwards ratified by the Engliſh parliament. King James was ſtruck with horror at hearing of the execution of his mother; but that ſpiritleſs prince could ſhow his reſentment no farther than by unavailing embaſſies and remonſtrances. France interpoſed in the ſame ineffectual manner; and on the 6th of December 1586, Elizabeth cauſed the ſentence of the commiſſioners againſt her to be proclaimed. After this ſhe was made acquainted with her fate, and received the news with the greateſt compoſure, and even apparent ſatisfaction. Her keepers now refuſed to treat her with any reverence or reſpect. They entered her apartment with their heads covered, and made no obeiſance to her. They took down her canopy of ſtate, and deprived her of all the badges of royalty. By theſe inſulting mortifications they meant to inform her, that ſhe had ſunk from the dignity of a princeſs to the abject ſtate of a criminal. She ſmiled, and ſaid, "In deſpite of your ſovereign and her ſubſervient judges, I will live and die a queen. My royal character is indelible; and I will ſurrender it with my ſpirit to the Almighty God, from whom I received it, and to whom my honour and my innocence are fully known." In this melancholy ſituation Mary addreſſed a magnanimous letter to Elizabeth, in which, without making the leaſt ſolicitation for her life, ſhe only requeſted that her body might be carried to France; that ſhe might be publicly executed; that her ſervants might be permitted to depart out of England unmoleſted, and enjoy the legacies which ſhe bequeathed them. But to this letter no anſwer was given.

818 The ſentence ratified by the Engliſh parliament.

In the mean time James, who had neither addreſs nor courage to attempt any thing in behalf of his mother, announced her ſituation to his bigotted ſubjects, and ordered prayers to be ſaid for her in all the churches. The form of the petition he preſcribed was framed with delicacy and caution, that the clergy might have no objection to it. He enjoined them to pray, "that it might pleaſe God to enlighten Mary with the light of his truth, and to protect her from the danger which was hanging over her." His own chaplains, and Mr David Lindſay miniſter of Leith, obſerved his command. But all the other clergy refuſed to proſtitute their pulpits by preferring any petitions to the Almighty for a Papiſt. James, ſhocked with their ſpirit of intolerance and ſedition, appointed a new day for prayers to be ſaid for Mary, and iſſued a ſtricter injunction to the clergy to obey him; and that he might be free himſelf from any inſult, he commanded the archbiſhop of St Andrews to preach before him. The eccleſiaſtics, diſguſted with his injunction,

819 Imbecillity of James, and extreme inſolence and bigotry of his clergy.